

VOCABULARY BUILDER – Tourism: Pros and Cons

The Advantages and Disadvantages of Tourism – Key Words • LEVEL A

The words and phrases below appear in the article *The Advantages and Disadvantages of Tourism*. Study the table carefully, then complete the gap-fill exercise in Part 2.

PART 1 – VOCABULARY TABLE

WORD / PHRASE	DEFINITION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
influx	a large number of people or things arriving at the same time	<i>The influx of tourists every summer puts enormous pressure on the local beaches.</i>
deplete	to use up or reduce the supply of something until very little is left	<i>Uncontrolled tourism can deplete natural resources and damage fragile ecosystems.</i>
social coherence	the feeling of unity, trust, and belonging within a community	<i>A sudden influx of visitors can gradually weaken the social coherence of a local area.</i>
erosion	the gradual wearing away of land, rock, or buildings by water, wind, or visitors	<i>Heavy footfall from tourists has caused serious erosion on many coastal paths.</i>
natural habitats	the natural environments where animals and plants normally live	<i>Unmanaged tourism can destroy the natural habitats of wildlife in protected areas.</i>
sheer	used to emphasize the large size or amount of something	<i>Even responsible tourists cause damage simply because of the sheer number of them.</i>
commercialization	the process of treating something as a product to make money from	<i>The commercialization of local culture reduces rich traditions to performances for tourists.</i>
undermine	to gradually weaken or damage something from within	<i>Mass tourism can undermine the authentic character and soul of a destination.</i>
inundated	flooded or overwhelmed with too many people or things	<i>Some towns are inundated with visitors in summer and almost completely deserted in winter.</i>
focal	being the main or most important part of something	<i>When tourism becomes too focal, other industries are neglected and the economy suffers.</i>
vulnerable	at risk of harm or damage; not well protected	<i>Countries dependent on tourism are vulnerable when numbers fall due to a pandemic.</i>
downturn	a period when business or the economy becomes worse	<i>A single economic downturn can destroy tourism-dependent communities almost overnight.</i>
exposed	introduced to something new, especially a different culture or idea	<i>Travelling abroad exposes you to unfamiliar traditions and broader ways of thinking.</i>

WORD / PHRASE	DEFINITION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
preconceptions	opinions or ideas formed before you have enough information or experience	<i>Travel can challenge our preconceptions about other cultures and the people who live there.</i>
stereotypes	oversimplified and fixed ideas about a group of people that are often wrong	<i>Meeting local people directly can help replace stereotypes with genuine understanding.</i>
first-hand knowledge	information or experience gained directly from personal involvement	<i>Travelling gives you first-hand knowledge that reading a book simply cannot provide.</i>
benign	harmless; not likely to cause offence or damage	<i>A gesture that seems benign in one culture can be considered deeply rude in another.</i>
infrastructure	the basic physical systems and structures a country needs to function	<i>Tourism provides an economic reason to invest in roads, rail, and local infrastructure.</i>
regenerate	to grow again or bring something back to a better condition	<i>Tourism income can be used to regenerate rundown areas and protect natural environments.</i>
cross-cultural	involving people or ideas from different cultures	<i>Travel promotes cross-cultural understanding and helps build bridges between societies.</i>
heritage	the traditions, buildings, and values passed down through generations	<i>Tourists should respect the cultural heritage of the places they visit.</i>
destination	the place someone is travelling to	<i>Bangkok is one of the most visited tourist destinations in the world.</i>
sustainable	done in a way that does not cause permanent damage to the environment	<i>Sustainable tourism aims to protect natural and cultural resources for future generations.</i>
dependence	the state of relying too heavily on something	<i>Economic dependence on tourism leaves a country vulnerable when visitor numbers drop.</i>

PART 2 – GAP-FILL EXERCISE

Complete the sentences using the correct word or phrase from the word bank below. You may need to change the form of the word. Some sentences need more than one answer.

WORD BANK

influx	deplete	social coherence	erosion
natural habitats	sheer	commercialization	undermine
inundated	focal	vulnerable	downturn
exposed	preconceptions	stereotypes	first-hand knowledge
benign	infrastructure	regenerate	cross-cultural
heritage	destination	sustainable	dependence

1	A huge _____ of visitors can gradually _____ the beauty and _____ of a tourist destination over time.
2	Tourism can cause serious environmental damage, including _____, pollution, and the destruction of _____.
3	Even responsible tourists cause harm simply because of the _____ number of them visiting popular sites.
4	The _____ of local culture can _____ its authenticity — turning rich traditions into acts performed for money.
5	Some coastal towns are _____ with visitors in summer but virtually deserted during a winter _____.
6	When tourism becomes too _____, other industries are neglected and countries become _____ to economic crises.
7	Travel _____ us to unfamiliar traditions, which can replace our _____ and _____ with empathy and real understanding.
8	Things that seem _____ in your own culture might be considered rude abroad — gaining _____ knowledge of customs is essential.
9	Tourism investment in _____ such as roads and hospitals can _____ entire regions and improve local life.
10	_____ travel aims to protect both the natural environment and the cultural _____ of a destination.
11	It promotes _____ understanding, building bridges between societies and creating long-term international connections.
12	Over-_____ on tourism is risky — countries with few other industries suffer most when visitor numbers fall suddenly.

Write your answers here:

1. _____	2. _____	3. _____
4. _____	5. _____	6. _____
7. _____	8. _____	9. _____
10. _____	11. _____	12. _____